

SPRING 2025 | Tu&Th 10:05-11:20am | Perkins Link 071 (Classroom 5)

POLISCI 190

SPECIAL TOPICS IN POLITICAL SCIENCE: POLICE, PRISONS & POLITICS

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COURSE OVERVIEW

This course is about the politics of the police and the prison system with a focus on the contemporary United States. The course addresses both substantive questions related to each of these topics, and introduces students to theories and quantitative methodologies that political scientists have used to study them.

The course is not a comprehensive overview of the politics of police and

prisons, but instead achieves its learning goals via a deep dive into a carefully selected set of three topic modules. The topic modules are: the behavior of the police; the consequences of police and prison contact for political participation; and prison gerrymandering.

Each of these modules mirrors key questions posed in the study of American politics, and the politics of democracies more broadly: how does the *demos* shape the actions of its representatives in government; why do people choose to participate in democratic politics; who is able to participate; and how does the government distribute resources to its citizen. All of these questions exist within the overarching question of how the state maintains *order*, and why and how the state chooses to punish in the service of producing order.

Each module involves a specific skill-building component in which students develop foundational skills related to theoretical political science, quantitative data analysis, or research design. These skills facilitate a framework and therefore a critical lens with which to analyze existing knowledge. Students then apply those skills to the substantive topic of the module via a cumulative module assignment.

MODULE 1 Police Behavior

What explains the behavior of the police? Why do the police sometimes protect and serve; while at other times they can coerce and even kill? This module addresses questions of police behavior by considering how institutions can and cannot produce accountability.

Big idea: Bureaucratic discretion is difficult to constrain.

Skill focus: Theories of bureaucratic accountability

Culminating assignment: Policy Memorandum

MODULE 2 Carceral Contact and Political Participation

How does contact with the police and prison system affect people's willingness and ability to participate in politics? This module considers questions about why individuals participate in politics, and how coming into contact with the police or prison system might change individual's desire and capacity to participate.

Big idea: The *demos* is made and re-made through its institutions.

Skill focus: Valid and reliable survey measures

Culminating assignment: Original Survey Module

MODULE 3 Prison Gerrymandering

Where are incarcerated populations represented? And how does that representation shape the distribution of government resources? This module considers the spatial distribution of incarcerated populations and how democracy distributes resources and shapes inequality as a result.

Big idea: Modern government is inescapably spatial.

Skill focus: Geographic Information Systems (GIS)

Culminating assignment: Map Analysis

OUR CLASSROOM COMMUNITY

It's important to be aware that we will cover topics in this course that are very sensitive, and others that may be highly personal. Together, we will work hard to cultivate a classroom environment that allows our presentation and discussions of these topics to be both intellectually rigorous and sensitive to differing opinions and perspectives. In being sensitive, however, we will not police each others thoughts, words or actions—nor self-police our own—but instead we'll keep our minds open, offer reasons for our views, whatever they may be, and be courageous in sharing as an intellectual gift we give to each other.

Like any instructor, I am not a neutral arbiter, devoid of personal opinion and perspective. Nor is my perspective anything beyond my own. But as an instructor, one of the skills that I have is significant *practice* in recognizing my own opinions and perspectives, and embodying different opinions at different times in order to present alternative arguments—one's you may not agree with! and one's vastly different from my own!—deliberately challenging your beliefs.

As the subsequent section describes, the learning goals of this class do not ask you to hold particular views on police, prisons or politics in the United States, nor to change the beliefs that you currently hold. Instead, the intellectual aims of our class center around the application of a social scientific approach to studying these potentially sensitive and personal topics. This social scientific approach builds skills that allow you to understand, as best as possible, *why the world works as it does*. This is different and distinct from questions of how the world *should* look. But the two are not unrelated—by

understanding why the world looks as it does, you'll gain a firm foundation from which to craft (in this course and beyond) your own sense of what the world *should* look like.

To succeed in class, what I ask is that you are willing to learn about, and actively practice, the perspective that a social scientist takes. Whether you adopt that perspective going forward is up to you.

LEARNING GOALS

Learning goals constitute the concrete, transferrable skills that you will obtain as a consequence of this course. By the end of the course, you will be able to:

1. *Understand.* You will be able to read for big ideas, author motivations, evidentiary support, and explicit/implicit assumptions in individual texts. And you will be able to draw content-based connections between texts by linking them, generating cumulative understanding beyond the individual texts.
2. *Describe.* You will be able to describe facts and empirical patterns related to each of the topic modules. Empowered with this descriptive information, you'll be better equipped to ask questions about how and why these patterns exist, support your own claims and opinions about whether these patterns should be as they are, and critique the claims and positions of others.

For example, you will be able to describe basic facts about how the police use force in their jobs in the first module; describe how citizens come into contact with the police in the second module; and describe where incarcerated populations are spatially within the US in relation to political boundaries in the third module.

3. *Explain and Apply.* You will be able to explain the logic of social scientific frameworks that aim to address *why* the world exhibits those patterns. In turn, you'll be able to apply those explanatory frameworks to the empirical patterns described above. For example, you'll be able to explain police behavior by applying the logic of the principal-agent framework; you'll be able to explain political participation by applying the resource model of civic engagement; and you'll be able to explain prison gerrymandering by applying framework of NIMBY preferences

and distributive politics.

4. *Analyze*. In explaining and applying, you will also develop skills in being able to critically analyze the logic and applicability of those frameworks. In doing so, you will be able to identify strengths and limitations of those and similar frameworks in explaining the political world.
5. *Create*. You will be able to create your own politically-relevant products in the form of maps, policy memos, survey questionnaires and opinion-editorials that aim to, alternatively, *i*) discover new information about the world, or *ii*) affect change in the world based on the existing state of knowledge.

ASSIGNMENTS

The following assignments are designed to help you to achieve the above learning goals. **Please note:** the full details of each assignment are provided on the course's website. In order to optimally complete the assignment, you must consult those instructions.

Module 1 Assignment — Policy Memorandum (20%)

DUE: Monday, February 17 by midnight (via Canvas)

In this assignment, you will select a problem related to the course's first module and propose a policy to solve it. You will write a concise policy memorandum that advocates for your policy to the relevant governmental stakeholder. You'll use relevant readings from class and high quality original research to justify the benefits of your policy solution relative to others and addressing any anticipated counterarguments.

Module 2 Assignment — Survey Module (20%)

DUE: Monday, March 17 by midnight (via Canvas)

In this assignment, you will design a survey module in order to address questions about carceral contact and political participation. Your survey module will be designed to measure particular beliefs, attitudes, behaviors, etc. from a particular population. You will design both the questions and response choices. Accompanying your survey module will be a short survey report that describes, among other things, what your module is designed to measure, why

you are interested in measuring those things, who your population of interest is, and why you believe your questions will allow you to validly and reliably measure those things. In the report you will also turn a critical lens on your own module, thinking about potential problems and limitations with the measures that you have designed.

Subject to Prof. Fresh's funding availability, your survey will be coded and fielded in order for you to observe real public opinion in answer to your questions.

Module 3 Assignment — Map Analysis (20%)

DUE: Wednesday, April 30 by noon (via Canvas)

In this assignment, you will produce between one and three maps that display information about incarcerated populations and political boundaries in a state of your choosing. These will be map(s) that you design and produce yourself based on GIS skills that you acquire during class and which follow key principles on how to properly present visual information. Accompanying your map(s) will be an Opinion Editorial (Op-Ed) addressed to a local or national news outlet that might be interested in your map. Your Op-Ed will clearly and concisely advocate an opinion related to your map(s), drawing from relevant frameworks and findings from our class readings and carefully calibrated outside research to support your claims.

Link Papers (20% total; 6%, 7%, 7% each)

DUE: #1 Thursday 1/30 by class time via Canvas; #2 Thursday 2/27 by class time via Canvas; #3 Thursday 4/10 by class time via Canvas

In this assignment, you will complete three separate papers of 2-4 pages each. Each paper will be associated with a given module. The papers ask you to select two readings from that module that you have read up to that point and put those readings in conversation with one another. In order to draw new connections between material beyond those that we've already drawn in class, you will select readings from different class sessions. You will make a claim about a content linkage between the two readings. This linkage is open ended—you can compare, contrast, draw implication linkages, cause/effect linkages, methodological linkages, historical linkages, etc. You'll develop your claim in your paper, demonstrating your understanding of the readings in isolation, and the additional meaning that can be generated when you actively engage

the readings together.

PARTICIPATION (20%)

We enrich our understanding of material by engaging with it together; learning from the insights of others; and pushing ourselves to reflect, question and respond when others have different understandings, perspectives and values about the world.

Therefore, a significant portion of your grade will depend on whether you have completed course readings, and your willingness and ability to engage in classroom activities, contribute to discussions, listen to your peers, and actively engage with me and them. Students should recognize that skimming readings is insufficient to achieve quality participation. Rather, I expect all students **not only to have completed readings prior to class, but to have also *thought* about them and *reflected* on them.** This does not require full comprehension, but it does necessitate attentiveness. When you do not comprehend the reading fully, you must be attentive to *what* you do not comprehend, and be willing to bring those questions to class.

As a reference point, simply attending every class merits a ‘C’ grade. No joke. Simply saying one thing per class in addition, really isn’t much better (C+ probably?). This should give you a clear indication that I have extremely high expectations for participation.

At the midway point in class, I will ask you complete a short survey with the participation grade that you think, based on how you have participated up to that point, you deserve to receive. This gives you an opportunity to reflect on your own participation and the expectations of the class; not to simply be told how you are doing. However, I will respond to your survey with information about your progress, and what you can do to improve.

LATE ASSIGNMENTS

I expect assignments to be turned in on time. Meeting deadlines is a critical “soft skill” in life. Assignments are due precisely when specified. Assignments will lose 1/3 of a letter grade (e.g. an assignment otherwise graded a B+ will be graded a B) for each 24 hours they are late unless we discuss in advance.

I understand, however, that life happens, and even when we have the best of intentions, unexpected things can happen, or we can fall behind and need a little help and compassion. If you are struggling to complete a given as-

signment on time, please reach out **before the due date**, if at all possible, to discuss how to complete the assignment in a way that won't affect in-class activities or snow-ball into further late assignments.

I will give you **one 72 hour grace period (extension) for one assignment during the term**. That is, you can turn in one assignment up to 72 hours late without consequence. Because of the registrar's grade submission deadline, you cannot use this grace period on the final assignment.

GRADING

Letter grades reflect your progress towards the learning goals outlined in a previous section of this syllabus. They are not measures of effort, but instead of learning. They follow the standard format:

98-100 A+	88-80.9 B+	78-79.9 C+	60-70 D
93-97.9 A	83-87.9 B	73-77.9 C	below 60 D
90-92.9 A-	80-82.9 B-	70-72.9 C-	

Cultivating a Growth Mindset

With all marks—whether on individual assignments or in the course overall—I strongly encourage you take a growth mindset. A growth mindset requires that you believe that your abilities are not fixed based on some immutable notion of intelligence or talent, but are instead under your control to develop and improve through dedication and hard work. If you receive a top mark, this doesn't mean that there isn't more to do and more to learn. Similarly, if you receive a low mark, this is in no way a referendum on your intelligence or your potential. Instead, it is a component of constructive feedback that is designed, with targeted feedback, to help you do better in the future.

THE HONOR CODE & AUTHORSHIP

Duke is a community dedicated to scholarship, leadership, and service and to the principles of honesty, fairness, respect, and accountability. Citizens of this community commit to reflect upon and uphold these principles in all academic and nonacademic endeavors, and to protect and promote a culture of integrity.

To uphold the Duke Community Standard:

1. I will not lie, cheat, or steal in my academic endeavors;
2. I will conduct myself honorably in all my endeavors; and
3. I will act if the Standard is compromised.

For more on the Duke Community Standard, please visit:

<https://studentaffairs.duke.edu/conduct/about-us/duke-community-standard>

On AI, Authorship and the Honor Code

My expectations for how you may use of AI (e.g., Chat GPT) follow the suggestions of the university:

1. Generally speaking, while you may use AI as a tool to assist you in your writing process, it may *not* be used as a replacement for your own critical thinking and writing skills. You should always be the primary author of your work and use AI only to supplement and enhance your own ideas.
2. If you use AI to generate text, you *must* properly cite the source in your assignment. Failure to do so is considered plagiarism. For example, if you use ChatGPT to generate text that you use verbatim, you must quote the generated text, and use the appropriate in-text citation format (e.g., footnote, endnote, in-line parenthetical) depending on which format you have chosen to use, and cite the tool in your formal reference list. If you generate text and adapt it (that is, paraphrase from it), you do not need to use quotations, but you must still cite the tool as described above. If you use AI only to edit your spelling/grammar (e.g., Grammarly) you should not cite the tool.
3. Do not use AI to complete assignments that are meant to be original works. If an assignment requires you to demonstrate your own critical thinking or problem-solving skills, using AI to generate the entire response would be considered a violation of Duke's Honor Code.

The assignments in this class ask you to produce original works that demonstrate your own critical thinking and problem-solving skills. AI may not be used to substitute for these components of your process.

I will compare your completed essays with an essay generated by AI with a prompt that reflects your chosen topic and the basic assignment parameters,

and I will utilize a AI detection software. In order to uphold the university honor code, I will have to initiate a plagiarism case in the event the above guidelines are not followed.

RESOURCES

Appointments

My office hours are listed on the first page of the syllabus. If you have a conflict with those office hours, you may schedule an appointment with me via email.

Please be *prepared* when you meet with me—make sure you know exactly what you want to gain from the meeting. If you have a brief question, you can ask over email instead. You can expect to receive a response within 48 hours.

Mental Health

Undergraduate study is ideally designed to stretch and build your intellectual abilities. Doing so necessitates criticism (though hopefully constructive). For many students who have aced school since day one, this is some of the very first true criticism that they've ever received, and it can be difficult to process. It also necessitates balancing many deadlines, learning how to set priorities and how to be OK with the inability to do everything perfectly.

Encountering these things means that taking care of your mental health is a critical component of school. Learning skills to manage stress, anxiety, criticism and disappointment will make you happier in life overall and a more successful student. If the burdens of study ever become too much, reach out to someone, anyone.

Contacts

Academic Resource Center

Find tutors, build your academic skills.

(919) 684-5917

theARC@duke.edu or arc.duke.edu

Thompson Writing Program

Schedule an appointment to discuss ways to improve as a writer.
<https://twp.duke.edu/>

Student Disability Access Office (SDAO)

For registration of accommodation needs and any other support.
sdao@duke.edu or access.duke.edu

Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS)

Make counseling appointments and seek referrals to outside therapists.
(919) 660-1000
<https://students.duke.edu/wellness/caps/CAPS>

TimelyCare (formerly Blue Devils Care)

Convenient, confidential, and free online mental health support.
bluedevilscares.duke.edu

DISABILITY ACCOMMODATION

Students with a documented disability should present me with their accommodation letter from the SDAO (see resources above) at their earliest ability. This letter allows me to follow university policy that accommodates disabilities while also protecting student privacy.

Students who need to obtain a letter are encouraged to reach out to SDAO as soon as possible and make sure that their instructor is informed that a letter can be expected at a later date. I cannot make accommodations based on a requested accommodation, only one that has been approved by the SDAO. Please make plans to obtain such accommodations in a timely manner.

COMMUNICATION

I will use email—both independently and through Canvas—to communicate with you outside of class. **I expect that you will check your email**

regularly and respond promptly (within 48 hours of receipt of an personally-addressed email that requires your action or acknowledgement).

Relatedly, please email me to communicate about any class topics. I pledge to respond to your email within 48 hours of receipt. Therefore, if you have a time-sensitive question related to a deadline, please plan ahead and ask your question with enough time for me to respond.

READINGS

All readings, unless specifically noted, can be found under the ‘Files’ tab and the relevant week on the course’s Canvas site. I expect you to undertake the readings prior to the class session for which they are listed. I aim to assign no more than 50 pages of reading per class.

Many readings are selections that are excerpted from a longer book, article or report. If you are interested in the full article, particularly if you are using the article in an assignment, please use the library to obtain the full copy.

SCHEDULE OVERVIEW

Week	Date	Class Topic	Assignment
1	Th 1/9	Introduction	
1	F 1/10	—	DUE: Online Pre-Assessment (midnight)
Module 1: Police Behavior			
2	Tu 1/14	How do the Police Behave?	
2	Th 1/16	Police as Bureaucrats	
3	Tu 1/21	Recruitment and Socialization	
3	Th 1/23	Accountability and Crime	
4	Tu 1/28	Accountability and Other Aims	
4	Th 1/30	<i>Reflection</i>	DUE: Link Paper #1 (by class)
5	Tu 2/4	Accountability to Whom?	
5	Th 2/6	Law Enforcement Influence	
5 7 F 2/7	—	DUE: Module 1 Topic (midnight)	
6	Tu 2/11	Experiments in Police Reform	
Module 2: Participation and Carceral Contact			
6	Th 2/13	Carceral Contact	
7	M 2/17	—	DUE: Module 1 Assignment (midnight)
7	Tu 2/18	Who Participates in Politics?	
7	Th 2/20	Concepts and Measurement	
8	Tu 2/25	Asking Questions on Surveys	
8	Th 2/27	<i>Reflection</i>	DUE: Link Paper #2 (by class)
8	F 2/28	—	DUE: Participation Self-Evaluation
9	Tu 3/4	Carceral Contact De-Mobilizes	
9	Th 3/6	Carceral Contact Mobilizes	
10	Tu 3/11	** No Class (Spring Break) **	
10	Th 3/16	** No Class (Spring Break) **	
Module 3: Prison Gerrymandering			
11	M 3/17	—	DUE: Module 2 Assignment (midnight)
11	Tu 3/18	Geography of Imprisonment	
11	Th 3/20	Drawing Political Boundaries	
12	Tu 3/25	Prison Gerrymandering	
12	Th 3/27	Strategically Gerrymandering	DUE: QGIS installation (by class)
13	Tu 4/1	<i>Librarian visit:</i> Using GIS	
13	Th 4/3	** No Class **	
14	Tu 4/8	Distributive Consequences	
14	Th 4/10	<i>Reflection</i>	DUE: Link Paper #3 (by class)
15	Tu 4/15	Reforming Gerrymandering	
15	Th 4/17	** No Class **	
Conclusion			
16	Tu 4/22	Conclusion	
	W 4/30	—	DUE: Module 3 Assignment (noon)

SCHEDULE

WEEK 1

Class 1 — Th 1/9 — Introduction

No readings.

MODULE 1: Police Behavior

WEEK 2

Class 1 — Tu 1/14 — How do the Police Behave?

Readings to be completed before class:

1. “Active Reading: to capture.” (1 page)
2. Shively (2012). *The Craft of Research*. 9th edition. (10 pages)
3. Levin (2024). “US police use force on 300,000 people a year with numbers rising since George Floyd: ‘relentless violence.’” *The Guardian*. (4 pages)
4. Garner and Maxwell (2024). “Measuring the Use of Force Used By and Against the Police in Six Jurisdictions.” (20 pages)
5. Walker et. al. (2001). “Early Warning Systems: Responding to the Problem Police Officer.” (8 pages)

Class 2 — Th 1/16 — Police as Bureaucrats

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Soss and Weaver (2017). "Police Are Our Government." *Annual Review of Political Science*. **(7 pages)**
2. Lipsky (1969). "Toward a Theory of Street-level Bureaucracy." *Institute for Research on Poverty Discussion Paper*. **(24 pages)**
3. McCubbins et. al. (1997). "Administrative Procedures as Instruments of Political Control." *Journal of Law, Economics & Organization*. **(13 pages)**

WEEK 3

Class 1 — Tu 1/21 — Recruitment and Socialization

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Oberfield (2014). "Socialization and Self-Selection: How Police Officers Develop Their Views About Using Force." *Administration and Society*. **(15 pages)**
2. Moskos (2008). "Chapter 1: The Departed." *Cop in the Hood*. **(19 pages)**
3. Moskos (2008). "Chapter 2: Back to School: The Police Academy." *Cop in the Hood*. **(20 pages)**

Class 2 — Th 1/23 — Accountability and Crime

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Gramlich (2024). “What the data says about crime in the U.S.” *Pew Research Center*. **(8 pages)**
2. Beckett (1994). “Setting the Public Agenda: ‘Street Crime’ and Drug Use in American Politics.” **(9 pages)**
3. Arnold and Carnes (2012). “Holding Mayors Accountable.” *American Journal of Political Science*. **(10 pages)**
4. The Wire (2003). https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xH_6_8N0fwI **(2 minutes)**

WEEK 4

Class 1 — Tu 1/28 — Accountability and Other Aims

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Mummolo (2017). “Modern Police Tactics, Police Citizen Interactions, and the Prospect for Reform.” *Journal of Politics*. **(6 pages)**
2. Rivera and Ba (2024). “The Effect of Police Oversight on Crime and Allegations of Misconduct: Evidence from Chicago.” *Review of Economic Studies*. **(14 pages)**
3. Makowsky and Stratmann (2009). “Political Economy at Any Speed: What Determines Traffic Citations?” *American Economic Review*. **(5 pages)**

Class 2 — Th 1/30 — Reflection

★ **DUE:** Link Paper #1 by class ★

No readings.

WEEK 5

Class 1 — Tu 2/4 — Accountability to Whom?

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Forman Jr. (2018). "Introduction." *Locking Up Our Own*. (14 pages)
2. Forman Jr. (2018). "'The worst thing to hit us since slavery': crack and the advent of warrior policing, 1988-92." *Locking Up Our Own*. (22 pages)
3. Hinton et. al. (2016). "Did Blacks Really Endorse the 1994 Crime Bill?" *The New York Times*. (3 pages)
4. Johnson and Kuhns (2009). "Striking Out: Race and Support for Police Use of Force." *Justice Quarterly*. (12 pages)

Class 2 — Th 2/6 — Law Enforcement Influence

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Robinson and Rushin (2022). “The Law Enforcement Lobby.” *Minnesota Law Review*. **(23 pages)**
2. Gonzalez (2023). “Reforming to Avoid Reform: Strategic Policy Substitution and the Reform Gap in Policing.” *Perspectives on Politics*. **(5 pages)**

WEEK 6

Class 1 — Tu 2/11 — Experiments in Police Reform

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Engel et. al. (2022). “Assessing the impact of de-escalation training on police behavior: Reducing police use of force in the Louisville, KY Metro Police Department.” *Criminology and Public Policy*. **(11 pages)**
2. Peyton et. al. (2019). “A Field Experiment on Community Policing and Police Legitimacy.” *Proceedings of the Natural Academy of Sciences*. **(5 pages)**
3. Landergan (2020). “The City that Really Did Abolish the Police.” *Politico*. **(13 pages)**

MODULE 2: The Participatory Consequences of Carceral Contact

Class 2 — Th 2/13 — The Nature of Carceral Contact

Readings to be completed before class:

1. BJS (2022). "Special Report: Contacts Between Police and the Public." (13 pages)
2. Turney and Connor (2019). "Jail Incarceration: A Common and Consequential Form of Criminal Justice Contact." *Annual Review of Criminology*. (13 pages)
3. Beckett and Goldberg (2022). "The Effects of Imprisonment in a Time of Mass Incarceration." *Crime and Justice*. (23 pages)
4. Weaver and Gellner (2024). "De-Policing America's Youth." *Crime and Justice*. (8 pages)
5. Huq (2017). "The Consequences of Disparate Policing: Evaluating Stop and Frisk as a Modality of Urban Policing." *Minnesota Law Review*. (9 pages)

WEEK 7

★ **DUE:** Module #1 Assignment, Monday 2/28 by midnight via Canvas ★

Class 1 — Tu 2/18 — Who Participates in Politics?

Readings to be completed before class:

1. van Deth (2014). "A conceptual map of political participation." *Acta Politica* (15 pages)
2. Verba et. al. (1995). "Beyond SES: A Resource Model of Political Participation." *American Political Science Review*. (15 pages)

Class 2 — Th 2/20 — Concepts and Measurement with Surveys

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Kellstadt and Whitten (2018). *The Fundamentals of Political Science Research*. Third Edition. **(17 pages)**
2. xx Tourangeau and Yan (2007). “Sensitive questions in surveys.” *Psychological Bulletin*. **(20 pages)**

WEEK 8

Class 1 — Tu 2/25 — Carceral Contact De-Mobilizes

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Weaver and Lerman (2014). “Political Consequences of the Carceral State.” *American Political Science Review*. **(14 pages)**
2. Sugie (2015). “Chilling Effects: Diminished Political Participation among Partners of Formerly Incarcerated Men.” *Social Problems*. **(16 pages)**
3. “The Fragile Families and Child Wellbeing Study (SURVEY OF PAR-ENTS) Mothers’ Nine-Year Follow-Up Survey Public Use Version” (2011). **(Browse for questions about police, incarceration and participation)**

Class 2 — Th 2/27 — Reflection

★ **DUE:** Link Paper #2 by class ★

No readings.

★ **DUE:** Participation Self-Eval, Friday 2/28 by midnight via Canvas ★

WEEK 9

Class 1 — Tu 3/4 — Carceral Contact and Mobilization

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Christiani and Shoub (2022). “Can Light Contact with the Police Motivate Political Participation?” *Journal of Race, Ethnicity and Politics*. (16 pages)
2. Walker (2014) “Extending the Effects of the Carceral State” *Political Research Quarterly*. (11 pages)
3. Burch (2021). “Not All Black Lives Matter: Officer-Involved Deaths and the Role of Victim Characteristics in Shaping Political Interest and Voter Turnout.” *Perspectives on Politics*. (14 pages)

Class 2 — Th 3/6 — Survey Questionnaire Workshop

★ **DUE:** Two draft survey questions by class ★

Readings to be completed before class:

WEEK 10

Class 1 — Tu 3/11 — ** NO CLASS (SPRING BREAK) **

Class 2 — Th 3/16 — ** NO CLASS (SPRING BREAK) **

MODULE 3: Prison Gerrymandering

WEEK 11

★ **DUE:** Module 3 Assignment, Monday 3/17 by midnight via Canvas ★

Class 1 — Tu 3/18 — Who is in Prison in America and Where

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Widra (2023). “Where people in prison come from: The geography of mass incarceration.” Prison Policy Initiative. <https://www.prisonpolicy.org/origin/2020report.html>
2. Wagner and Kopf (2015). “The racial geography of mass incarceration.” Prison Policy Initiative. <https://www.prisonpolicy.org/racialgeography/report.html>
3. Keller and Pierce (2016). “A Small Indiana County Sends More People to Prison Than San Francisco and Durham, N.C., Combined. Why?” *The New York Times*. <https://www.nytimes.com/2016/09/02/upshot/new-geography-of-prisons.html>
4. xx Jessica Simes

Class 2 — Th 3/20 — Drawing Boundaries

Readings to be completed before class:

1. <https://redistricting.lls.edu/redistricting-101/where-are-the-lines-drawn/>
2. <https://electionlab.mit.edu/research/redistricting>
3. McGee Partisan Gerrymandering and Political Science
4. Canon Race and Redistricting

WEEK 12

Class 1 — Tu 3/25 — Prison Gerrymandering Pt. 1

Readings to be completed before class:

1. DOJ (). “Guide to State Voting Rules That Apply After a Criminal Conviction.” **(Read about a few states)**
2. Ebenstein (2018). “The Geography of Mass Incarceration: Prison Gerrymandering and the Dilution of Prisoners’ Political Representation.” *The Fordham Urban Law Journal*.
3. Hamsher, “Counted Out Twice” (12pg)
4. Remster, Brianna and Rory Kramer. 2018. “Shifting Power: The impact of incarceration on political representation.” *Du Bois Review* 15(2):417–439.

Class 2 — Th 3/27 — Prison Gerrymandering Pt. 2

★ **DUE:** Install QGIS by class ★

Readings to be completed before class:

1. The strategic use of prisons in partisan gerrymandering JP Kelly - Legislative Studies Quarterly, 2012

WEEK 13

Class 1 — Tu 4/1 — *Librarian Visit: Using GIS*

Video to be watched before class:

1. <https://youtu.be/4LyfcdHmgmU?si=sZu0t3nz7-v067mT&t=244>
(Timestamp: 4 minute to 30 minute)
2. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SovdBaus7pM>

Class 2 — Th 4/3 — ** NO CLASS **

WEEK 14

Class 1 — Tu 4/8 — *Are There Distributive Consequences?*

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Rich. Federal Grants
2. Tax Policy center. What types of federal grants.
3. Lotke and Wagner (2004). "Prisoners of the Census: Electoral and Financial Consequences of Counting Prisoners Where They Go, Not Where They Come From." *Pace Law Review*.
4. King et al, "Big Prisons, Small Towns: Prison Economics in Rural America" (19pg)

Class 2 — Th 4/10 — *Reflection Day*

★ **DUE:** Link Paper #3 by class ★

No readings.

WEEK 15

Class 1 — Tu 4/15 — *Reforming Gerrymandering*

Readings to be completed before class:

1. “Implementing Reform: How Maryland and New York Ended Prison Gerrymandering.”
2. Prison Policy Initiative. 2021. “How many states have ended prison gerrymandering? About a dozen*!”
3. Williamson (2022). “Redistricting and incarceration: Examining the electoral consequences of New York’s prohibition on prison gerrymandering.” *State Politics and Policy Quarterly*

Class 2 — Th 4/17 — * NO CLASS *****

Conclusion

WEEK 16

Class 1 — Tu 4/22 — *Conclusion*

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Levin (2018). “The Consensus Myth in Criminal Justice Reform.” *Michigan Law Review*.